Minutes of the
General Government Committee Meeting
Held Electronically at 1:00 p.m. on December 14, 2020

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
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Present:	Chair - Councillor	L. Bower
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		A. Khan
	Mayor	S. Collier

1. Call to Order

Chair Bower called the meeting to order at 1:00 p.m. and provided an overview of the electronic meeting format.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interests.

3. Adoption of Minutes

3.1 Regular Meeting

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of the General Government Committee held on November 9, 2020 be adopted.

CARRIED

3.2 Closed Session Minutes

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Closed Session Minutes of the regular meeting of the General Government Committee held on November 9, 2020 be adopted.

CARRIED

With consent of all Members, Items 6.1 and 6.2 were advanced in the order of business.

6.1 **Regional Chair's Update**

Regional Chair John Henry discussed and highlighted projects and initiatives completed across the Region over the past year. He shared the Durham Region Momentum 2020 Video highlighting regional projects and accomplishments and spoke about those taking place in Ajax. Regional Chair Henry shared information on the regional proclamation of December 14-20, 2020 as "Shop in Durham Week".

The Committee asked questions regarding low emissions targets, regional diversity initiatives, regional support for municipal concerns with the Durham Scarborough Bus Rapid Transit project, Durham Regional Police Services recruitment, zoning challenges associated with modular housing, and correspondence from the Region's solicitor pertaining to development agreements and recent proposed zoning by-law amendments in the Town.

Regional Chair Henry responded to questions from the Committee and thanked Town of Ajax Staff and Council for their continued efforts during the pandemic. On behalf of the Committee, Chair Bower thanked Regional Chair Henry for his update.

6.2 **Durham Community Fund Update**

Vivian Curl, Executive Director, Durham Community Foundation, delivered a presentation highlighting the Durham Community Foundation and Town of Ajax 2019 funding and project impact, flow-through funding distributed to organizations within Ajax, allocation of an Emergency Community Support Fund grant, and supports provided to existing local charities.

Committee Members asked questions regarding pandemic impact on 2021 supports and donors, and direct and indirect impacts of service. Ms. Curl responded to questions from the Committee and provided clarification on funding and donation sources. Chair Bower thanked Ms. Curl for her presentation on behalf of the Committee.

4. Consent Agenda

Members separated items 4.1, 4.2, and 4.4 for discussion.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

That items 4.3 and 4.5 of the consent agenda be adopted.

CARRIED

4.1 **Cannabis Clustering – Response to City of Hamilton**

Committee members asked questions regarding recent closures of cannabis growing facilities in Ontario and impacts on proposed cannabis retail locations in Ajax. Rachael Matheson, Senior Advisor, Government and Stakeholder Relations, responded to questions from Committee members.

Moved by: S. Collier

That Council endorse the correspondence received from the City of Hamilton included as ATT-1 to this report.

CARRIED

4.2 **2020 Financial Sustainability Plan Update**

Committee members asked questions relating to the SWOT analysis included within the report, impacts of increased multi-residential/mixed-use development on the tax base, spending caps, stabilization reserve, investment growth and risk, projected growth of reserves within the next year, impacts of a possible deficit on the 2021 budget, capital funding levies, timelines for Elexicon to resume dividends, summary of grant funding received by the Town since the hiring of the Grants Partnerships and Strategic Initiatives Coordinator, alternative investment programs, and time sensitivity of the Financial Sustainability Plan.

Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer, and Danna Munns, Senior Financial Analyst, responded to questions from Committee members. Shane Baker, Chief Administrative Officer, noted that a report summarizing grant funding received by the Town will be brought forward to a forthcoming meeting.

Main Motion

1. That Council approve the following updated policies: • #120 – Financial Sustainability Plan:
    - #122 – Discretionary Stabilization Reserves
    - #123 – Discretionary Capital Reserves
    - #124 – Debt Management (previously Long Term Debt Management)
    - #127 – Capital Expenditure Control

2. That Council adopt Policy #125 – Federal Gas Tax, a policy to guide the administration and use of funds received by the Town of Ajax under the Federal Gas Tax program.

Motion to Refer

Moved by: S. Collier

That the 2020 Financial Sustainability Plan Update be referred to the January 18, 2021 meeting of the General Government Committee.

CARRIED

4.3 **Municipal Elections - Contribution Rebate Program Implementation**

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

That the by-law to authorize the Contribution Rebate Program for the 2022 municipal election, included as ATT-2 to this report, be approved by Council.

CARRIED

4.4 **Contract Award – Rotary Park Boardwalk**

Committee members sought clarification on the necessary timing of the project this year,

involvement of the Toronto and Region Conservation Authority with a shoreline management strategy, design, and expected lifespan of the proposed bridge.

Andrew Jackson, Landscape Architect, and Dave Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services, responded to questions from the Committee.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That Council award the contract for the Rotary Park Boardwalk construction, to Rutherford Contracting Ltd. in the amount of $1,063,396.33 (inclusive of all taxes).

2. That Council award the contract administration, inspection and geotechnical services to exp Services Inc. in the amount of $119,061.32 (inclusive of all taxes).

CARRIED

4.5 **Assumption of Subdivisions**
(18T-98014) – Castlefields Subdivision Phase 2
(18T-98014, S-A-2003-02) – Castlefields Subdivision Phase 4
(S-A-2003-02) – Castlefields Subdivision Phase 5

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

(1) That the works and services within the following Plans of Subdivision be assumed by the Town:

a) (18T-98014) – Castlefields Subdivision Phase 2 Owner: Medallion Developments (Castlefields) Limited Agreement Date: October 19, 2004 Registered Plan: 40M-2228 Refer to Appendix “A”

b) (18T-98014, S-A-2003-02) – Castlefields Subdivision Phase 4 Owner: Medallion Developments (Castlefields) Ltd. & Audley Rd. Holdings Ltd. Agreement Date: August 30, 2008 Registered Plan: 40M-2386, 40M-2387 Refer to Appendix “B”

c) (S-A-2003-02) - Castlefields Subdivision Phase 5 Owner: Medallion Developments (Castlefields) Ltd. & Audley Rd. Holdings Ltd. Agreement Date: November 15, 2010 Registered Plan: 40M-2449 Refer to Appendix “C”

(2) That the corresponding Assumption By-laws be prepared for an upcoming Council meeting.

CARRIED

5. Discussion

5.1 **Capital Pre-Budget Approval – 2021**

Dave Meredith, Director of Operations and Environmental Services, reviewed the contents of the written report and recommendations contained therein. Committee Members requested that future project requests indicate the Ward association.

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That Council provide pre-budget approval in the amount of $650,000 for the 2021 Road Resurfacing capital project (ENG013), funded from Roads Maintenance

Reserve;

2. That Council provide pre-budget approval in the amount of $1,850,000 for the 2021 FGT Road Resurfacing capital project (ENG043), funded from Federal Gas Tax Reserve Fund;

3. That Council provide pre-budget approval in the amount of $350,000 for the Harwood Avenue EA – Taunton to Woodcock capital project (ETP015), funded from:

Development Reserve	$17,500
Development Charges 2018	$332,500
	$350,000

4. That Council provide pre-budget approval in the amount of $9,076,400 for the Rossland Road Widening - Church to Westney – Construction (ENG036), funded as follows in 2021 and 2022:

	2021	2022	Total
Development Reserve	$757,900	$768,100	$1,526,000
Development Charges 2018	$3,720,300	$3,770,100	$7,490,400
Developer Contribution Collected	$60,000	-	$60,000
Total	$4,538,200	$4,538,200	$9,076,400

5. That Council provide partial pre-budget approval in the amount of $40,000 for the 2021 Hardware Replacement capital project (ITS002), funded from Vehicle and Equipment Replacement Reserve.

CARRIED

5.2 Ajax-Pickering Hospital (Lakeridge Health) Long-term Care Facility and Construction Office - Development Charge Agreements

Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, reviewed the contents of the written report and recommendations contained therein. Members of the Committee inquired whether the agreement poses any cost impact on the Town. Sean McCullough, Senior Development Planner, responded to questions from the Committee.

Moved by: A. Khan

1. That staff be authorized to prepare, and the Mayor and Clerk be authorized to execute, the necessary agreements with Lakeridge Health for the proposed Long Term-care Facility and associated construction office, to:

   a. defer the calculation of development charges to a date other than prescribed in the *Development Charges Act*; and

   b. facilitate early payment of development charges to a date other than prescribed in the *Development Charges Act*;

   subject to the agreements being deemed satisfactory by the Director of Planning and Development Services, Director of Finance / Treasurer, and the Town's Solicitor prior to execution.

CARRIED

6. Presentations

6.3 Ajax Visual Identity Update

Rachael Wraith, Manager of Corporate Communications, and David Ramesar, Corporate Graphic Designer, presented an overview of the modernization of the Town of Ajax visual identity. She discussed the modern design introduced in 2020 for the Town's 65th Anniversary. D. Ramesar discussed a digital refresh of materials, graphics, and print collateral that implemented the new visual identity, including the Town's COVID-19 public awareness campaign. R. Wraith discussed plans to continue developing the corporate visual identity program to include refreshing internal and external templates and corporate clothing.

Members of the Committee asked questions regarding the advantages and priority of changing the visual identity, and opportunities for Council to provide feedback. Members indicated hesitancy for adopting an acronym (TOA) as a Town identifier and changing Town clothing, and asked questions regarding how the project relates to the corporate identity project deferred to 2024 during the 2020 budget process.

R. Wraith responded to questions from the Committee and indicated that an updated visual identity manual will be brought to a forthcoming meeting for additional feedback.

6.4 Bridge #1003 Rehabilitation/Bank Stabilization Project Scope Change and Trans Canada Trail Church Street and Highway 401 Contract Award

Ranil Fernando, Manager of Infrastructure and Capital Projects, delivered a presentation outlining three options for rehabilitation and bank stabilization of the Trans Canada Trail on Church Street and Highway 401, due to erosion of the bridge abutment and trail. He discussed options to abandon existing trail alignment, stabilizing banks and retaining the structure in-situ, and relocating the bridge and trail approaches. He discussed washout of the Church Street trail and staff recommendations included within the report.

Committee Members asked questions regarding completion of a structural assessment, timelines on implementation of the three options, connection of the trail to Elizabeth Street, financing of the project, cost estimates for design and construction, long-term solutions, warranty on construction, current closure and barriers on the affected section of the trail.

Members of the Committee discussed the various options presented, project budget, and safety concerns associated with the site. D. Meredith, G. Romanowski, and R. Fernando responded to questions from the Committee. D. Valentim provided clarification regarding the financial aspects of the project.

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That Council approve the change in scope to Capital Account No. 1013711 – Pedestrian Bridge #1003 Repairs, allowing for the budget to be utilized for Option 1 as detailed in this report at an upset limit of $100,000 (net of HST rebate).

2. That Council directs staff to continue to explore Options 2 and Option 3 as a long term sustainable solution including potential external funding sources

3. That Council approve the transfer to the General Infrastructure Reserve in the amount of $180,000 from the scope reduction of Capital Account No. 1013711 – Pedestrian Bridge #1003 Repairs.

4. That Council award the contract for the detail design and repair of Trans Canada Trail at Church Street and Highway 401 to Toronto Regional Conservation Authority (TRCA) in the amount of $103,449.07 (inclusive of all taxes).

5. That Council approve funding of $123,266.78 to be allocated to Capital Account No. 1017311 from General Infrastructure Reserve.

CARRIED

6.5 **Community Improvement Plans – Workshop #1**

Michael Sawchuck, Senior Planner delivered an information workshop on the Town's Community Improvement Plans (CIPs). He discussed the purpose of CIPs, reasons for use, scope, and the Town's two CIPs. He presented information on the Downtown CIP and Pickering Village CIP boundaries and program components. M. Sawchuck discussed review of the CIPs and outlined reasons for concern. He presented information on double development charges impacts and shared an overview of development charges for sample projects. Information on Town response, CIP suspensions, CIP commitments, and CIP commitments specific to Medallion developments were shared. M. Sawchuck discussed actions taken and growth scenarios. An overview of the Central Ajax Intensification Servicing and Transportation Study (CAIST) and Recreation Parks and Culture Master Plan impacts and directions were presented.

Members of the Committee asked questions regarding the Pickering Village Heritage Conservation District boundaries and property designations, sign grant program and façade improvement program. M. Sawchuck responded to questions from the Committee.

7. Adjournment (4:55 p.m.)

Moved by: S. Collier

That the December 14, 2020 meeting of the General Government Committee be adjourned.

CARRIED

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Chair

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Acting D-Clerk